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INDIA’S CHINA POLICY UNDER MODI

Growing co-operation, enduring disagreement, increasing rivalry

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Since taking up office in 2014, the government of Prime Minister Narendra Modi has pursued a particularly proactive and forward-leaning foreign policy. The government has worked to engage India’s neighbouring countries while also building more comprehensive relations with global powers. Of particular note are India’s policy and actions regarding China, a growing power and presence in India’s neighbourhood.

Under Modi, India has taken a somewhat sharper tone in its relationship to China. For example, with respect to disputed areas and also the triangular relationship of India–China–Pakistan, India has taken a slightly tougher stance. It has hardened its position somewhat, and there has been an increase in anti-Chinese sentiments expressed by the Indian public. The Modi government has also shown a slightly greater willingness to voice India’s views. However, at the same time that the tone has become sharper under Modi,